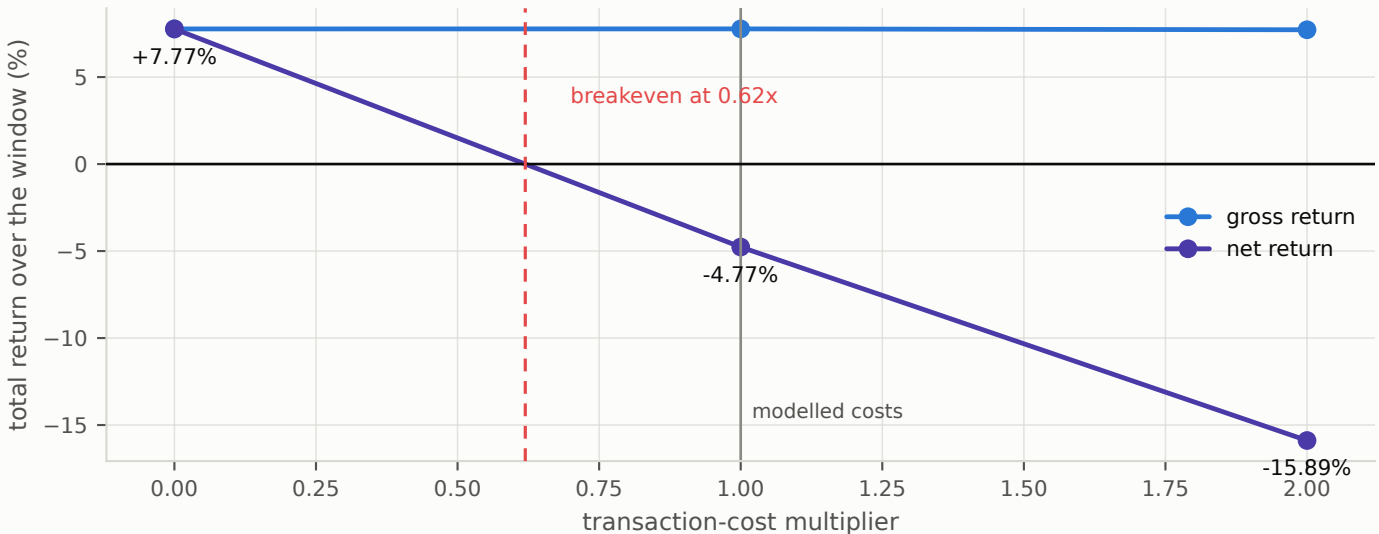


Fixed decisions, varying cost: where the edge disappears



Decisions are held fixed across the three cases, so only the bill moves; net return is monotonically decreasing in the cost multiplier. Breakeven sits at 0.62x the modelled cost, so the gross edge is exhausted below the costs an actual desk would pay.